MOUNTAINSIDE

May 1994 Volume 2 Issue 5

THE INFRASTRUCTURE UPGRADE & EXPANSION SAGA

MORE EFFORT REQUIRED BEFORE MEMBERS VOTE

The CMA Board of Directors has had its hands full. Responding to member viewpoints and suggestions for final resolution of the CDC-CMA dispute, leaders have scheduled business meetings, developed executive summaries of recently accomplished studies and fact-finding reports and planned an information dissemination program. All this is to be done before members vote again on Board recommendations to accomplish infrastructure upgrades. Expansion of the community is controversial in some quarters, so every effort is being made to address the concerns of members. Some members are opposed to any increases in assessments. On May 7th, the Board examined the throes of creating a utility and coming under the regulatory authority of the West Va. Public Service Commission. According to the PSC, this became a requirement once it was evident that CMA had more than 25 water hook-ups. We are now exploring having established utilities take over our systems. Some members want more information about the form of entity CMA would have to create in the event existing utilities are not interested in acquiring and managing CMA systems. Efforts to settle on specific CMA-CDC management procedures to be followed in the event of an expansion approval are also on the front burner. Tree cutting is one of the most important issues facing CMA. New approaches to this subject will be formulated by a special task force. Informing members about all these matters is #1 priority.



CMA member Lincoln "Lon"Dring was recently recognized in the Washington Post as a top community leader in Montgomery Co. Lon has devoted his life to outreach programs for the poor and hungry. Congratulations!

NOTICE

PARKING CARS
The parking lot at this home is designed to accommodate only one car per bedroom. This strict limitation is designed to insure safety to persons walking, to keep noise levels to a minimum, and to keep fire lanes open. Any additional cars at any time must be left at the parking lot by the barn.

FIRES
Open burning is not permitted. If barbecue equipment is provided with the house, care is to be exercised with such activity.

OCCUPANTS
A two (2) person per bedroom limit has been set.

A twenty-five ($25.00) charge will appear on the bill for infractions.

A new agreement between CMA and CRI has this notice being distributed to people renting homes. It is suggested for all landlords.

An Editorial From the President

SPEAKING OF TRAILS, HOW ABOUT A *PAPER TRAIL ?*

At the risk of bringing up a dull, dull subject, paper in the form of reports may be the salvation of our association. As a volunteer organization, we're lucky enough to have people conduct our business, no less require them to fill out forms or file reports. As one member recently told me when I suggested a more formalized management structure; "We're no IBM. We're just a family of volunteers and we've been doing very nicely over all the years . . thank you." *In my view we're a business with customers and outside clients* which take the form of a developer, health department, security company, road paver, assessor and a cast of other characters. Internally, there is an *official* team of people who do the work and must communicate well with each other. We also have *unofficials* who talk at will about their views on how to run everything from the association to the infrastructure. Yes, it's free speech, but much time is lost by chasing unsubstantiated rumors. From my vantage point, complaints or suggestions in writing, with observations about tree cutting or construction practices placed on the proper forms will provide each administration with the true story, this as opposed to a rumor mill that has a tendency to exaggerate in what I now call ***tales from the woods.*** We've just issued a simple form that asks the observer to put h/her name and date on paper and spell out observations by describing real or potential problems. We've enclosed one with this newsletter. Please use it. Thanks.

If you are interested in serving on the special task force regarding future tree cutting, contact chair Linda Clark at (301) 588-1331. The group will define terms like tunneling and vistas and recommend procedures for developers and architects involved in adjusting mother nature's handiwork.

Annual Meeting Date Set For Sept. 3rd

The CMA annual meeting will be held on Saturday September 3rd at Coolfont Resort. The meeting has usually attracted a good crowd and issues debated set a tone for the new fiscal year. The election of Board members is conducted and a report on progress from the past year is given. This year's meeting will feature an all member get-together at the end of the session to celebrate accomplishments, recognize retiring Board members, congratulate new leaders and meet new neighbors.

CDC has agreed to voluntarily abide by inspection standards in the proposed agreement and apply them to "S" section infrastructure work.

WELCOME NEW MEMBERS Richard F. Kaufman and Dilys M. Parry (lot R-3). YES, you'll find us to be one big happy family!

MARTHA ASHELMAN RECOGNIZED FOR ACHIEVEMENTS

Its been a good year for Martha. She was elected Vice President of the International Spa and Fitness Association. In addition, Coolfont's Swim and Fitness Center and Spectrum Spa & Salon run by Martha features passive and active solar technology and for that innovation, Martha collected a first place award for continued commitment to environmentally sensitive development and resource management. To top matters off, she just picked up business woman of the year ('93) honors from the W.V. Woman's Commission .

Congratulations Martha!

COOLFONT FOUNDATION
Pianist Peter Basquin May 28 - 8:30
W.V. Film Festival Tour June 11-8:30
Borowski & Towson St. Cello Ens. June 18-8:30

JUDGE NEILL SERVES CMA IN MANY CAPACITIES

He's 'Ed' to us but Judge Neill to those lawyers who appear before him. As CMA secretary, he provides us with the most accurate set of minutes we could ever hope for. Keeping people honest is a mission for this officer and all year long he's had plenty to do as an arbitration committee member, board member and advisor to the CMA President. Ed negotiated a settlement on the White Trail to meet requirements set forth in the '86 agreement. Ed's wife, Kathy, has been interrupted by CMA calls all year, but always manages to keep her good sense of humor. Maybe its her background as a professor or the profession she helps to strengthen, *nursing*; who knows? Ed is a graduate of the Georgetown University Law Center and a member of the VA. Bar. In Oct. of '86, he was appointed Board Judge to the General Services Board of Contract Appeals. Since then he has managed an active docket regarding disputed Government contract claims and awards of Government contracts for automated data processing equipment and service. He received the Defense Logistics Agency Meritorious Civilian Award in 1981 and the Exceptional Civilian Award in 1985. The Neills' son Ted, attends Paul VI High School in Fairfax.

Thanks Ed and Kathy for your support

Da Pool Boss, Da Pool . . .CMA TO REOPEN FACILITY ON MEMORIAL DAY

It won't be beautiful, but it will be clean and safe. Our swimming pool needs work but funds remain in short supply. Until CMA settles on a financial plan to upgrade the pool and tennis courts, our members will have to get by. Enclosed with this newsletter is a sheet spelling out information about the operation of the pool: Some highlights: Pool opens Memorial Day weekend . Hours on Fri. & Sat. are 11:00 am to 7:00 pm. Sundays, 11-4., Weekdays (M-Th) beginning June 13th, 1-5 pm. There is a jacuzzi, and for a small fee, it can be used by members outside normal hrs.of operation.





John and Maggie Dowling, she of our Long Range Budget Planning Committee, will be off to Copenhagan in July. Maggie's final words, "fix this mountainside before we get back!"

AGGRESSIVE WATER TESTING PROGRAM
Testing of water sources (wells) is now in progress. Mineral and chemical tests are being conducted to assure that drinking water remains safe and in compliance with W.V. standards. We test for metals and chemicals. Hardness, alkalinity, color, total dissolved solids, nitrates, nitrites, lead and copper are some of the tests we've ordered. Some are required.